

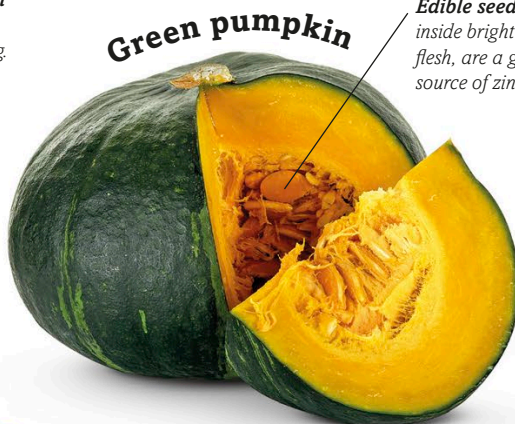


All squashed up!



Cushaw pumpkin

This stripy squash can grow up to 19½ in (50 cm) long.



Green pumpkin

Edible seeds, held inside bright yellow flesh, are a good source of zinc.



A hooked neck gives this warty yellow squash its name.

Crookneck squashes



The round fruits change color from green to orange as they ripen.

Pumpkin



PLUMP PUMPKIN



Heaviest pumpkin
2,624 lb
(1,190.5 kg)



Hatchback car

The world record for the heaviest pumpkin ever grown was in 2016 for a fruit weighing 2,624 lb (1,190.5 kg), around the same weight as a hatchback car.

Although they are typically eaten as vegetables, squashes are actually the fruits of creeping vine plants that belong to the gourd family. There are many types of squashes, and they come in lots of curious shapes.

Almost all species of squash originally come from Central and South America but are now grown around the world, particularly in India and China. These large and fleshy fruits are rich in vitamins. The vitamin content is particularly high in squashes with orange and yellow flesh, such